

How to Tell Wild Animals by Carolyn Wells



Summary

It is a humorous poem that tells dangerous ways to identify wild animals. If a large tawny beast roars loudly at you in the jungle it is the Asian Lion. If a noble beast with black stripes on yellow coat eats you it is the Bengal Tiger. If a spotted beast leaps on you again and again it is the Leopard. If a creature hugs you very hard it is a Bear. Hyenas smile and Crocodiles weep.

Chameleon is a small lizard with no ears and no

wings, if you see nothing on a tree and then see something it is the Chameleon. The humour is that you will know the animal only when it attacks you.

📖 সাৰাংশ.

বনৰীয়া জীৱ-জন্তু চিনাক্তকৰণৰ বিপজ্জনক উপায়ৰ কথা কোৱা হাস্যৰসময়ী কবিতা। জংঘলত যদি কোনো ডাঙৰ টাউনি জন্তুৱে আপোনাৰ ওপৰত জোৰেৰে গৰ্জন কৰে তেন্তে সেয়া হ'ল এছিয়ান লায়ন। হালধীয়া কোটত ক'লা ৰেখা থকা সম্ভ্ৰান্ত জন্তু এটাই যদি আপোনাক খায় তেন্তে সেয়া হ'ল বংগ বাঘ। যদি কোনো দাগযুক্ত জন্তুৱে আপোনাৰ ওপৰত বাৰে বাৰে জপিয়াই পৰে তেন্তে সেয়া হ'ল নাহৰফুটুক। যদি কোনো জীৱই আপোনাক অতি জোৰেৰে সাৱটি ধৰে তেন্তে সেয়া হ'ল ভালুক। হাইনাছে হাঁহিছে আৰু কুমিৰবোৰে কান্দিছে। চেমেলিয়ন এটা সৰু টিকটিকি যাৰ কাণ আৰু ডেউকা নাই, যদি আপুনি গছত একো দেখা নাপায় আৰু তাৰ পিছত কিবা এটা দেখা পায় তেন্তে সেয়া হ'ল চেমেলিয়ন। হাস্যৰসটো হ'ল যেতিয়া জন্তুটোৱে আপোনাক আক্ৰমণ কৰিব তেতিয়াহে আপুনি সেই জন্তুটোক চিনি পাব।

- 1. Tawny: Brownish-yellow colour**
 - 2. Beast: Wild animal**
 - 3. Noble: Royal / Dignified**
 - 4. Leap: To jump high**
 - 5. Roar: Loud cry of a lion**
 - 6. Camouflage: To change colour to hide**
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□□□□□Important Questions and Answers:□□□

1. How can you identify the Asian Lion?

Ans: You can identify it by its large body, tawny colour and loud roar that makes you feel you will die of fear.

2. How can you identify the Bengal Tiger?

Ans: You can identify it by its black stripes on yellow body. It will eat you when it meets you.

3. How does the poet describe the Leopard?

Ans: Leopard has spots on its skin and it leaps on its prey again and again. It is useless to cry for help.

4. How can you identify a Bear?

Ans: If a creature hugs you very very hard while walking in your yard, it is a Bear.

5. How can you differentiate between a Hyena and a Crocodile?

Ans: A Hyena always smiles and a Crocodile has tears in its eyes. This is how you can differentiate them.

6. What is special about a Chameleon?

Ans: Chameleon is a small lizard with no ears and no wings. It changes its colour according to its surroundings and becomes invisible.

Thinking about the Poem

1. Does 'dyin' really rhyme with lion? Can you say it in such a way that it does?

Ans: No, 'dyin' does not really rhyme with 'lion' if pronounced correctly. But the poet has used poetic liberty. If we pronounce 'lion' as 'li-own' and 'dyin' as 'dy-in' with similar stress, it creates a close rhyme. It is done to maintain the rhythm and humour of the poem.

2. How does the poet suggest that you identify the lion and the tiger? When can you do so, according to him?

Ans: The poet says if you go to the jungle in the east and a large tawny beast roars at you so loudly that you feel you are going to die of fear, it is the Asian Lion. And if a noble beast with black stripes on yellow body eats you while you are roaming, it is the Bengal Tiger. According to him,

you can identify them only when they attack or kill you.

3. Do you think the words 'lept' and 'lep' in the third stanza are spelt correctly? Why does the poet spell them like this?

Ans: No, the words 'lept' and 'lep' are not spelt correctly. The correct spellings are 'leapt' and 'leopard'.

The poet spells them like this for two reasons:

1. To maintain the rhythm and rhyme of the poem with 'lep' rhyming with 'pep'.
2. To create humour and give a conversational and light-hearted tone to the poem.

4. Do you know what a bearhug is? It's a friendly and strong hug such as bears are thought to give, as they attack you! Again, hyenas are

thought to laugh, and crocodiles to weep (crocodile tears) as they swallow their victims. Are there similar expressions and popular ideas about wild animals in your own language(s)?

Ans: Yes, a bearhug is a very tight, strong and affectionate hug.

Yes, there are many similar expressions in English and in our own languages:

In English:

- Cunning as a fox
- As brave as a lion
- To shed crocodile tears (fake crying)
- As sly as a hyena

In my language (Assamese / Hindi) also there are similar ideas:

- Xiyalor dore dhurt – means cunning like a fox.

- Singhor dore xahoxi – means brave like a lion.
- Bhalukor dore xaboti dhora – bear hug, very tight hug.
- In Hindi we say "Magarmach ke aansu" for crocodile tears.
- "Sher jaisa dil" means brave like a lion.
- "Lomdi jaisa chalak" means cunning like a fox

This shows that in every language, people associate human qualities with animals.

5. Look at the line "A novice might nonplus". How would you write this correctly? Why is the poet's incorrect line better in the poem?

Ans: The correct line would be "A novice might be nonplussed" or "A novice might be confused".

The poet's incorrect line is better because:

1. It maintains the rhythm and rhyme scheme of the poem.
2. Nonplus rhymes with Chameleon in the next line as "nonplus – chameleon" with short, funny sound.
3. It makes the poem sound more humorous and casual.

6. Can you find other examples of poets taking liberties with language, either in English or in your own language(s)? Can you find examples of humorous poems in your own language(s)?

Ans: Yes, poets often take liberties with language.

In English: Poets like Sukumar Ray in his nonsense poems or Lewis Carroll in Jabberwocky uses words like "slithy, mimsy".

In Assamese: Poet Lakshminath Bezbarua in his humorous poems uses funny made-up words and wrong grammar for humour. For example in his poem "Mor Desh" and funny limericks. Also poets use Assamese words like "O morom loga" in a funny twisted way to make it rhyme.

We can also find humorous poems by Hiren Bhattacharya or Nirmal Prabha Bordoloi for children which have funny rhymes.

7. Much of the humour in the poem arises from the way language is used, although the ideas are funny as well. If there are particular lines in the poem that you especially like, share these with the class, speaking briefly about what it is about the ideas or the language that you like or find funny.

Ans: The line I like most is: "If he roars at you as you're dyin' / You'll know it is the Asian Lion..."

I like it because:

1. Idea is funny: you will know it is a lion only when you are about to die from fear, so identification is useless.
2. Language is funny: the forced rhyme of lion and dyin makes us laugh.

Another line is "A bearhug" – it is funny because a bear's hug is not loving but it will kill you, but poet says it as a friendly hug.
